Dorsaf Sallami

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Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher, Mila – Québec AI Institute Jan 2026 – Present

- Advisors: Reihaneh Rabbany (McGill University) and Jean-François Godbout (Université de Montréal).
- Lead *Veracity*, an open-source AI fact-checking initiative cited in Canada's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy as an example of impactful Canadian AI research.
- Veracity added to the Senate of Canada's resources for senators and staff in May 2026.
- Member, Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship.

Education

Ph.D. **Université de Montréal**, Computer Science Sept 2022 – Dec 2025

- **Supervisors:** Professor Esma Aïmeur and Professor Gilles Brassard
- **Areas:** NLP, Responsible AI, and Fake News Detection
- **Distinction:** Rector's Honour List, 2025–2026 (top 10% of doctoral graduates in the program).

M.Sc **Université de Montréal**, Computer Science Sept 2020 – Aug 2022

- **Supervisor:** Professor Esma Aïmeur
- **Areas:** Fake News Detection, Multimodal Data, Explainable AI

M.Sc. **Higher Institute of Applied Sciences and Technology, Tunisia** Sept 2017 – Aug 2020

- Software Engineering (Master's equivalent)
- Advanced systems design, software engineering, and applied computing

B.Sc. **Higher Institute of Applied Sciences and Technology, Tunisia** Sept 2015 – Aug 2017

- Mathematics, Physics, Computer Science (Bachelor's equivalent)
- Preparatory cycle for national engineering program

Professional Development

Stanford University, *Ethics, Technology, and Public Policy for Practitioners* Fall 2026

- Live cohort-based professional program on technology ethics, public policy, and responsible innovation.

Selected Publications

J: Journal article; C: Conference paper; W: Workshop paper

1. **[C]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Aletheia: Detect, Discuss, and Stay Informed on Fake News**. Proceedings of the Thirty-Fourth International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence, IJCAI-25, p.11109–11113.
2. **[C]**AÏMEUR, Esma, BRASSARD, Gilles, and SALLAMI, Dorsaf. **Too Focused on Accuracy to Notice the Fallout: Towards Socially Responsible Fake News Detection**. Proceedings of the AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society. Vol. 8. No. 1. 2025.
3. **[J]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Explain Further: Multi-Level Explanations for Fake News Detection Using Large Language Models**. International Journal of Information Technology, 2025, p. 1-8.
4. **[J]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Exploring beyond detection: a review on fake news prevention and mitigation techniques**. Journal of Computational Social Science, 2025, vol. 8, no 1, p. 1-38.
5. **[C]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Does Gender Matter? Examining and Mitigating Gender Bias in Fake News Detection**. International Symposium on Foundations and Practice of Security. Springer, Cham, 2025. p. 249-266.

6. **[J]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Fairframe: a fairness framework for bias detection and mitigation in news**. AI and Ethics Journal, 2024, p. 1-17.
7. **[W]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, GUEDDICHE, Ahmed, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **From Hype to Reality: Transformer-Based Models for Fake News Detection Performance and Robustness Revealed**. In 3rd Workshop on Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies. IJCAI 2023.
8. **[C]**SALLAMI, Dorsaf, BEN SALEM, Rim, and AÏMEUR, Esma. **Trust-based Recommender System for Fake News Mitigation**. In: Adjunct Proceedings of the 31st ACM Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation and Personalization. 2023. p. 104–109.
9. **[J]**ABDALLAH, Wejden, KANZARI, Dalel, SALLAMI, Dorsaf, et al. **A deep reinforcement learning based decision-making approach for avoiding crowd situation within the case of Covid'19 pandemic**. Computational Intelligence, 2022, vol. 38, no 2, p. 416–437.
10. **[C]**AMRI, Sabrine, SALLAMI, Dorsaf, et AÏMEUR, Esma. **Exmulf: an explainable multimodal content-based fake news detection system**. In: International Symposium on Foundations and Practice of Security. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2021. p. 177–187.

Academic Service and Leadership

- **Workshop Organiser** — Disinformation and Misinformation under the lens of Generative AI Safety, AAAI 2027
- **Workshop Organiser** — 5th Workshop on Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies,, The ACM Web Conference 2027
- **Designated Coordinator** — IVADO Thematic Semester: Information Integrity in the Age of Generative AI, 2027
- **Topic Editor** — *"AiOfAi: Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies"*, *Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence*, 2026
- **Social Event Organiser** — *Who Decides What Counts as True?*, ACM FAccT 2026, June 2026, Montréal; sponsored by Mastercard.
- **Contributing Expert** — Global Trust Challenge, 2026
- **Workshop Organiser**— 4th Workshop on Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies, The ACM Web Conference 2026 —Proceedings
- **Content Contributor** — CYBER project (HEC Montréal, IMC2, Centre de formation en langues des affaires), "Comment éviter la propagation de fausses informations en ligne ?" — 2025
- **Publicity Chair** — 3rd Workshop on Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies, 32nd International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI), 2023 —Proceedings
- **Reviewer for** — International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI); AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES); Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS); AAAI; and AI and Ethics Journal

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Université de Montréal

- **IFT2015/IFT6002 – Data Structures** *Winter 2023, 2024, 2025*
  Led laboratory sessions, assessed assignments, and provided individualized support during office hours.
- **IFT6261 – Knowledge Processing** *Winter 2024*
  Assessed assignments and supported students during office hours.

Tutor, Tutoring 2.0 Program, Université de Montréal *Fall 2022*

- Provided academic support to undergraduate students in computer science courses.

Research Supervision and Mentorship

Sukanya Krishna, Ph.D. Student — **Harvard University**, Jan. 2026 – Present
- Research project: *Ambiguity and Underspecification in AI-Assisted Fact-Checking*

Tong Wu, Undergraduate Research Intern — **McGill University**, Summer 2026
- Research project: *Multi-Turn Fact-Checking with Large Language Models*

Andrew Lin, Undergraduate Research Intern — **McGill University**, Summer 2026
- Research project: *Claim Augmentation for Fact-Checking*

Hugh Kelly, Undergraduate Research Intern — **McGill University**, Winter 2026
- Research project: *Source Preferences Affect Trust in Large Language Models*

Arpad Botond Rigo, Undergraduate Research Intern — **Université de Montréal**, Summer 2023
- Research project: *Simulation of Fake News Propagation*

Talks, Presentations, and Media Coverage

- **Invited Speaker**, LATECE Seminar, Université du Québec à Montréal (UQAM): "Peut-on confier la vérification des faits à l'IA ? Promesses, limites et perspectives" — October 2026 | Montréal, Canada | Presented in French
- **Guest Lecturer**, Knowledge Processing (IFT 6261), Université de Montréal: "Information Integrity in the Age of Generative AI" — October 2026 | Montréal, Canada
- **Invited Speaker**, Community of Inquiry in AI Ethics, Curtin University: "Why Accuracy Isn't Enough When AI Decides What Counts as True" — July 2026 | Online
- **Co-Author, Opinion Article** — "Construire la confiance, au-delà de l'urgence d'adopter l'intelligence artificielle", *Le Devoir*, July 2026
- **Media Interview**, Knowable Magazine article, "AI shows promise in the fight against fake news", interviewed by journalist Katya Zimmer — June 2026
- **Research Media Coverage**, UdeMNouvelles article "Fake news: do the tools meant to protect us actually mask their flaws?" featuring my research on socially responsible fake news detection; also covered by Tech Xplore and shared by Crickit.ai — March 2026
- **Poster Presenter**, 8th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES): "Too Focused on Accuracy to Notice the Fallout: Towards Socially Responsible Fake News Detection" — October 2025 | Madrid, Spain
- **Presenter**, Forum INCYBER Canada (delegation of the Centre for Cybersecurity Belgium) — October 2025 | Montreal, Canada
- **Poster Presenter**, 34th International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI): "Aletheia: Detect, Discuss, and Stay Informed on Fake News" — August 2025 | Montreal, Canada
- **Speaker**, First Canada–Denmark Municipal Knowledge Exchange Webinar: "RAG4MuniESG: ESG Assessment for Municipal Sustainability through Retrieval-Augmented Generation, a Quebec Case Study" — June 2025 | Online
- **Poster Presenter**, Journée de la Recherche du DIRO: "CoALFake: Collaborative Active Learning with Human-LLM Co-Annotation for Cross-Domain Fake News Detection" — May 2025 | Montreal, Canada
- **Presenter**, 17th International Symposium on Foundations & Practice of Security (FPS): "Does Gender Matter? Examining and Mitigating Gender Bias in Fake News Detection" — December 2024 | Montreal, Canada
- **Speaker**, Innovate4Cities Conference: "What Do Policy, Planning, and Reporting Documents Reveal About Urban Sustainability Initiatives? Patterns and Insights from AI-Assisted Textual Analysis" — September 2024 | Montreal, Canada
- **Speaker**, 15th International Sustainability Transitions Conference (IST): "Nature and Biodiversity in Urban Sustainability Transition Planning and Reporting Documents: Patterns and Insights from AI-Assisted Textual Analysis" — June 2024 | Oslo, Norway (Online)

- **Speaker**, Cyberconference: “Beyond the Facts: Fake News, Generative Artificial Intelligence, and Cybersecurity” — April 2024 | Montreal, Canada
- **Speaker**, Inaugural Event of the Multidisciplinary Institute for Cybersecurity and Cyber Resilience (IMC^2): “Explainable System for Countering Fake News and Doxxing” — October 2023 | Montreal, Canada
- **Presenter**, 3rd Workshop on Adverse Impacts and Collateral Effects of Artificial Intelligence Technologies: “From Hype to Reality: Transformer-Based Models for Fake News Detection Performance and Robustness Revealed” — August 2023 | Macao, China (Online)
- **Poster Presenter**, 31st ACM Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation and Personalization (UMAP) — October 2022 | Limassol, Cyprus
- **Speaker**, Annual Canadian Celebration of Women in Computing Conference (CanCWIC): “Multimodal Content-Based Fake News Detection System” — October 2022 | Toronto, Canada
- **Guest Lecturer**, Knowledge Processing (IFT 6261), Université de Montréal: “Multimodal Content-Based Fake News Detection System” — February 2022 | Montreal, Canada

Scholarships

- **2020–2025:** First nationwide recipient of the Tunisian Government Scholarship for studies in Canada, awarded by the Tunisian Ministry of Higher Education (2020).
- **Fall & Winter 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025:** DIRO Excellence-Writing-Support Scholarship, Université de Montréal

Research and Industry Experience

Circle Medical, AI Research Intern — Montreal, June 2025 – Sep 2025
- Designed and implemented an evaluation framework for 10/CPT code prediction and HPI/Plan summary generation
- Developed quantitative metrics and procedures to measure model performance systematically.
- Benchmarked and compared several LLMs (OpenAI, Anthropic).

AlphaFixe Capital (Mitacs), AI Research Intern (Part-time) — Montreal, Jan 2024 – May 2025
- Research intern in Artificial Intelligence applied to sustainable finance
- Python, NLP, Data Analysis, Data collection, LLM

Videotron, Data Analyst Intern — Montreal, May 2023 – Aug 2023
- Data Cleaning, Data Integration, Data Visualization
- Python, NetSuite, Databases

Société Générale, BI - Data Analyst Intern (Part-time) — Montreal, Sep 2021 – April 2022
- Data Cleaning, Data Integration, Data Visualization
- Python , JS , GitHub , JSON , Databases, REST/POST Data visualisation, Power BI

ITPEAC, End of Studies Internship — Tunisia, Feb 2020 – July 2020
- An approach to optimizing decision-making in a crisis based on deep reinforcement learning. Case Study: COVID-19

Technical Skills

Programming Languages: Python, Java **Web Development:** Angular.js, Flask **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, NLTK, Scikit-learn, Keras, OpenCV **Documentation:** LaTeX, Markdown

Languages

Arabic (Native), French (Professional), English (Professional), Turkish (Beginner), Spanish (Beginner)

Extra-Curricular Activities

- **2021–2025:** Lab Leader, *AI Lab for Cybersecurity*, Montreal
- **2019–2020:** Training Manager, *ARSII Association*, Tunisia
- **2018–2020:** Treasurer, *ISSATSo Data Science Club*, Tunisia
- **Personal Interest:** When I'm not debugging code or mentoring students, you'll probably find me hiking up a trail